



depths of engagement with our audiences. Our gardens are delightful examples of performative art. They change every season, indeed every day, of their existence. Smithsonian Gardens' staff horticulturists and gardeners are extraordinarily knowledgeable when it comes to plant science, yet so much of their work evolves into genuine artistry thanks to their natural skill in combining living collections.

Perhaps the fascinating information and engaging photographs in *Trees, Leaves, Flowers & Seeds* will launch an inquisitive child's journey into the mesmerizing world of plants.

Cynthia Brown

Smithsonian Gardens Education and Collections Manager

Throughout this book, you will find scale boxes that show the sizes of plants compared to either a child, a school bus, or a human hand.



Child = $4\frac{3}{4}$ ft
(1.45 m) tall



School bus = 36 ft
(11 m) wide



Hand = 6 in
(16 cm) long

